

Budget Apple

Apple planning cheaper, smaller iPhone:
<http://bit.ly/em14lr>

Yet another tablet

HP to showcase tablets, smartphones:
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Avoiding Mobile Menace

Prevent unnecessary hassles due to handhelds

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Cellular telephony is no longer limited to the rich and famous. This mode of communication has its charm amongst masses throughout the world. In the past decade, it has become the common man's necessity. You can now access the internet on your mobile via Wi-Fi, click pictures and shoot videos using extremely high resolution cameras. Add to that an on-the-go MP3 player. In the midst of all these conveniences, it has its share of disadvantages. There are few suggestions a mobile consumer needs to keep in mind to avoid incidental problems. One of the major issues that concern the mobile user today is unwanted telemarketing calls and messages. Although such information is meant to be inacces-

sible both legally and ethically, both mobile network corporations and their employees earn a major chunk of their profits by selling customer database to telemarketing organisations. As a result, you are flooded with numerous unwanted calls by such organisations endorsing their services. The potential threat of such unsolicited calls lies not only in the nuisance they create, but there is a fair chance that the person on the other side can induce you reveal such vital information that can be detrimental to your interests. For example, they can offer you some lucky gift, discount coupons or dinner at some petty restaurant in exchange of some vital information related to your bank account, office timing, age, relatives, and family members. You may have told a teller caller that you and your spouse are

information and even transferred money on false promises of winning lotteries abroad.

Apart from making you vulnerable to fraud and cheating, it causes nuisance which is painstaking. You may be rushing to the office or to some emergency that needs your ultimate priority. In the midst of it all, you find yourself answering a call which is nothing less than idiotic. Moreover, at times due to such pesky calls, we miss important calls.

Legally speaking your provider has to maintain your privacy intact which if breached should be compensated. The mobile company can be held liable for passing on any information without the consent of the consumer. The consumer must register with the DND (Do Not Disturb) directory. It is duty of the company to dis-

close to the consumer in case the mobile number was being used by some other consumer in the past. If they do not adhere to such compliances, such conduct becomes

actionable. The service provider can be held vicariously liable for any damages caused due to such infringement. Above all, prevention is better than cure. So the next time, just be careful when your mobile phone screen displays an unknown number. **■**



We can help!

If you're facing a problem with your purchase, write to us at help@consumermate.com

working professionals and generally return home late everyday. Inadvertently, what you have just revealed is that your home is quite prone to theft during the active hours of the day. That apart, many have given their bank account details and credit card

COMPLAINTS RECEIVED

Mobile Phones

Faulty Videocon motherboard

Question: I am already blaming myself for my decision to buy a Videocon mobile phone. Its quality is the same as Chinese phones. Service centres take months to repair. Within three months of buying it, its motherboard got damaged by itself. The service centre guys are saying it's not covered under warranty and need to pay 70 per cent of the price of a phone to replace it.

Prashant

Answer By Consumermate

Dear Prashant,
 Thanks for sharing your inputs and suggestions regarding the product and services that may be beneficial could guide prospective customers. Do not feel

cheated this way, as you can very well take legal action by lodging a complaint with the district consumer forum. We suggest you write them a registered letter containing all the details of your complaint. In case, they do not come up with a solution, then you may go ahead with complaint in the district forum.

Lemon mobile not working fine

Question: I purchased a Lemon duo 211 with dual SIM in February 2010. Within a month it started malfunctioning. I went to some service centres, but they say they won't be able to do anything, and asked me to send it to the company service centre. I am now in Chennai. I want to know whether there are any service centres of Lemon in Chennai

M Murali

Answer By Consumermate

Dear Murali,
 You can challenge the dealer and the company with regard to your phone. At this stage, we suggest you to write them a registered letter containing all the details of your complaint. In case they do not come up with a solution, then you may go ahead with a complaint in the district forum.

We hope some sense will prevail over them at the stage of issuing a notice itself, and they will sort out matter with you. And, yes maintain a record of all communications that may be necessary in the future as evidence. It may tough for you to go to the consumer forum, but sometimes even the filing of a complaint is sufficient to move them.